



YOU ARE **4 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

247 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The embryo, still less than 3 mm long, now has a deep and narrow groove extending along its entire length. This groove will soon become so deep and its edges will curl over so much that it forms into a tube running along the length of the embryo.

“ Although there’s lots of information to take in, try to enjoy this time and remember pregnancy is a natural process. ”

No sooner than you found out you were pregnant, like most expectant women, you may have begun to worry about all aspects of your lifestyle and your unborn baby’s health. To put things in perspective, remember that in generations gone by pregnancy was considered to be a natural event, and few women made lifestyle changes to accommodate the condition. So in the past, pregnant women were likely to continue eating unhealthy foods, drinking alcohol, and smoking.

Furthermore, pregnancy tests tended to be much less accurate or sensitive, meaning that many pregnancies ended in early miscarriage without anyone being aware. For this reason, many of the problems now known to be risk factors for pregnancy complications or miscarriage were not analyzed or addressed, or worried about.

Today, with the benefit of a great deal of research, and precise monitoring of ovulation, conception, and pregnancy, women are very aware of what is happening inside their bodies, and are informed about the potential pitfalls. This is a mixed blessing: while it is important to avoid anything known to adversely affect your unborn baby, it is equally important to relax and enjoy the pregnancy, because stress is not good for you or your baby.

ORGANIC FOODS

Organic foods in the US can be fortified. Organic foods are usually preferable, but for dairy alternatives, such as soy milk, make sure that the minerals such as calcium and iodine that milk supplies have been added.

ASK A DOCTOR

I’m 40 and in great shape. Will the doctors still see my pregnancy as potentially high-risk?

Women over age 40 are at higher risk in pregnancy from conditions such as diabetes, high blood pressure, problems with the placenta, and birth complications. They are also at an increased risk of having a baby with a chromosomal disorder.